

Truck Company Operations Manual — Quick Guide

The manual's core message: **Engines look at what IS burning. Trucks look at what is NOT burning.** That's what drives every truck function below. Benchmark: the first 7 of the 10 functions should be complete or in progress within the first 5–10 minutes on scene.

1. Apparatus Positioning

Mindset: "Position, don't park." Truck gets priority — leave room for it.

- **Rear-mount:** most efficient off the sides/rear; nose-in and stop short to extend over cab
- **Mid-mount (Towers):** "Spot the Bucket," not the turntable — align platform corner with the target; lower center of gravity, better visibility, but less forgiving around obstructions
- **Collapse zone:** 1.5–2x building height
- **1st Truck:** near the first engine, side of initial entry
- **2nd Truck:** opposite the first truck — Charlie side often best for commercial/apartments (utilities, extra egress, less parapet)

2. Personnel Configurations

- **Unified Team:** whole crew together — commercial ventilation, master streams, RIT, wide-area search
- **Split Team:** Inside Team (Officer + Right FF — forcible entry, primary search) / Outside Team (Engineer + Left FF — VEIS, ventilation, egress forcible entry, utilities)
- Company retains its call sign unless a member calls in individually by riding position (e.g., "T16 Firefighter Left")

3. The 10 Functions (in priority order)

1. Coordinated Forcible Entry/Exit
 2. Search & Rescue
 3. Coordinated Ventilation
 4. Recon (360/Roof/Charlie)
 5. Ground Ladders
 6. Elevated Master Streams
 7. Utility Control
 8. Salvage
 9. Overhaul
 10. RIT
- Last-arriving truck defaults to **Active RIT** unless assigned otherwise.

4. Forcible Entry

Gap-Set-Force: soften with strikes → crush with the Adz → pry toward the door → set forks if needed → pry again.

- **Residential (inward-swinging):** Adz at 90° in the jamb gap; passive entry (K-Tool, through-the-knob) often better for non-emergent calls
- **Commercial front (glass/metal frame):** protect glass integrity — passive entry (K-Tool) first; goal 30–45 sec
- **Commercial rear (solid/hollow metal):** irons; flat-head axe as wedge + halligan
- **K-Tool steps:** flush over lock → drive halligan into loop → pry to pull cylinder → manipulate tumbler with key tool → door opens

5. Search & Rescue

- **Primary search:** quick but thorough, under fire/smoke conditions
- **Secondary search:** slow, methodical, AFTER control + ventilation — ideally a *different* crew
- **Search types:** Oriented, Split, RASP (rope-assisted, wide-area), VEIS (targeted window search)
- **VEIS steps:** break/clear window top-down → sound floor, TIC scan → go straight to the door → sweep hallway → close door → search room using TIC landmarks
- **Victim found:** radio "Victim, Victim, Victim" + CAN report
- **Mobile homes:** bedrooms on the ends; VEIS is primary tactic; sound floors (thin subflooring)
- **Non-compartmentalized (>3,500 sq ft):** rely heavily on TIC; link up with attack team as a Suppression Group; 3-member search team recommended

6. Ventilation

Three types: **Vertical, Horizontal, Positive Pressure** — always coordinated with the attack team.

- **Vertical:** cut over/near the seat of the fire; **4'x8' minimum** (not the old 4'x4'); sounder leads (first up, last down); walk the ridge; residential benchmark **<90 seconds**, commercial **4–6 minutes**
- **No-Go's:** fully involved with no searchable space, non-IDLH interior, no top-floor/attic involvement, imminent roof collapse
- **Half-story/knee wall:** Half-Story Long Cut, ridge to soffit, spanning 2 rafter bays
- **Milwaukee Cut:** steep non-walkable pitch + knee walls; 3-person crew, 2 saws, 3 ladders
- **Trench cut:** cut ahead of fire to stop lateral spread in common-attic apartments; needs 2+ crews
- **Horizontal:** windows/doors at the fire level; coordinate — never break glass blind
- **PPA (Positive Pressure Attack):** locate fire room on 360 → break exhaust window → fan at door → charge line → turn fan in → wait 15–60 sec → enter/attack

7. Reconnaissance

- **360:** every incident, ideally by the Truck Officer — look for fire location, searchable spaces, construction features
- **Charlie Side/Roof Report:** simple CAN-style report to Command (what you see, what you need, what you're doing)
- **Rescue/Survivability Profile:** any space without heavy fire = searchable and must be searched
- **Construction red flags:** half-stories (steep pitch, gable windows), 2-story-with-bonus (interconnected voids), basements/split-levels (walkout basements = LODD risk)

8. Laddering

- **Aerial = primary ladder**, backed up by ground ladders — every offensive fire gets laddered
- Single-story: ladder opposite the fire (vent team travels least-to-most involved)
- Multi-story/apartments: aerial to roof or upper-floor window immediately
- Roof ladders: needed for steep/half-story pitches, but cost 60-90 extra seconds
- Ground ladder heat sensors: preset **300°F**

9. Elevated Master Streams

- Nozzle must be switched from rescue mode → **waterway mode** before flowing
- **Corners** = most stable position for large commercial/collapse-zone buildings
- Firefighter posted at the tip to aim safely before flow — 1,000 GPM = 16 gallons/second, treat the nozzle like a cannon

10. Utility Control

Priority order: Electrical → Gas → Water. Never supersedes search, ventilation, forcible entry, laddering (unless the utility is feeding the fire).

- **Cutting the loops:** hot stick only, cut each black hot wire separately at staggered lengths, leave the silver neutral — never cut both hots simultaneously
- **Pulling the meter:** residential only (meter = fuse); commercial meters are "flow meters" — **never pull commercial meters**, use breaker panel/main shutoff instead
- **Gas:** quarter-turn perpendicular at the meter; **immediate priority at lightning-strike fires** (CSST risk)
- **Water:** lowest priority; usually at the curb

11. Rapid Intervention (RIT)

- **Passive RIT:** stages with tools, awaits activation
- **Active RIT** (standard expectation): 360, remove window bars, soften doors, deploy extra ladders — stays ready to walk away and respond instantly
- **RIT Pack:** spare SCBA cylinder + facepiece on aerial apparatus; stage near the building, don't carry it into a blind search
- **Project Mayday stats:** most common mayday = lost/separated from hoseline (18.3%); 87.7% resolved by self/crew; only 7.9% resolved by RIT; peak risk window 20–35 min on scene

12. Salvage

- Tarps/visqueen (covers a 12x12 room); group belongings to center of room, cover
- Ventilation, laddering, and overhaul are all forms of salvage too — don't let it wait for "traditional" tarp-and-cover only
- Never supersedes search and rescue

13. Overhaul

- Truck typically stays until overhaul is complete (ranking officer usually on scene)
- Look for hidden fire in walls/floors/ceilings after knockdown — balance thoroughness against unnecessary property damage

14. Other Tactical Considerations

- **3-person staffing:** covered under S6xxx staffing procedures — one member may be down-staffed for training without losing full response capability
- **Quint Model:** blurs strict truck/engine role lines — crew must know whether their apparatus has a pump/tank

15. Mid-Rise Operations (3+ stories, <75 ft)

- **1st Aerial:** Suppression + Division Supervisor — recon, suppression support
- **2nd Aerial:** Inside Truck — evacuation, ventilation
- **3rd Aerial:** Outside Truck

16. High-Rise Operations (4+ stories or evacuation impractical)

- **1st Truck:** Suppression Group + Division Supervisor — size-up, lobby recon, fire floor division, hallway/stairwell stretch

- **2nd Truck:** Lobby — Lobby Officer, Fire Control Room FF, Building Systems FF, Elevator Operator
 - **Elevator Operator confirms:** Phase 1 recall occurred, Phase 2 function, auto-shutoff, Hold feature — never take the car below 2 floors above the lowest fire floor, never to basement levels
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Universal Threads Across the Manual

- **All buildings are occupied until proven otherwise.**
- **Conditions drive tactics** — the manual gives principles, not rigid rules.
- **Communicate constantly** — CAN reports, 360s, roof reports all feed Command's situational awareness.
- **The Truck supports the Engine** — every function exists to make the fire attack safer and faster.